

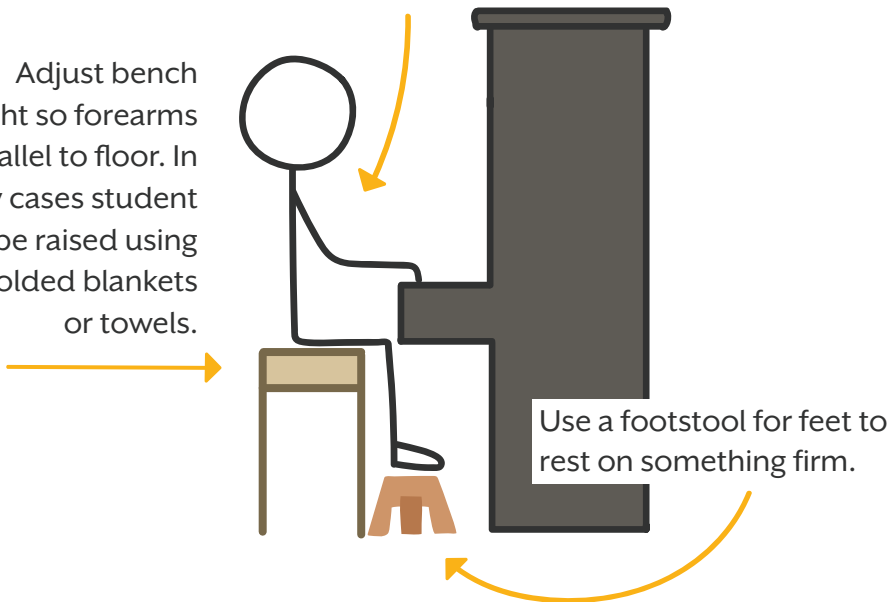
Piano Posture Checklist

Every time you sit to play the piano, first go through the Piano Posture Checklist.

1 Bench Position

Elbows will float slightly in front of torso when bench position is just right.

Adjust bench height so forearms are parallel to floor. In many cases student must be raised using folded blankets or towels.



Too far



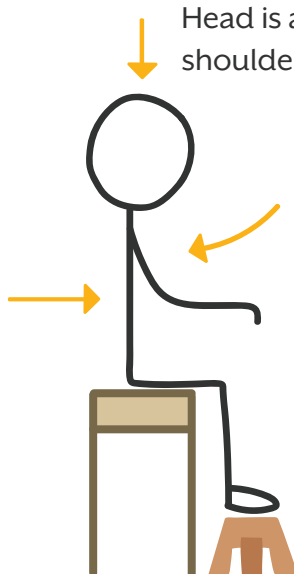
Too close

2 Tall Back

Head is aligned over shoulders and hips.

Shoulders are relaxed and down.

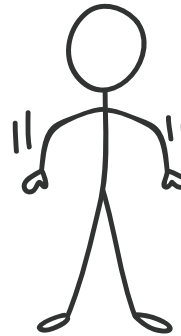
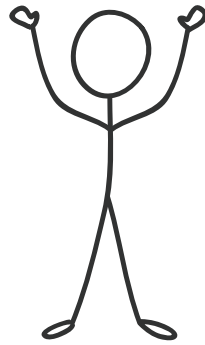
Back is comfortably tall and flexible.



Avoid a
slouched back

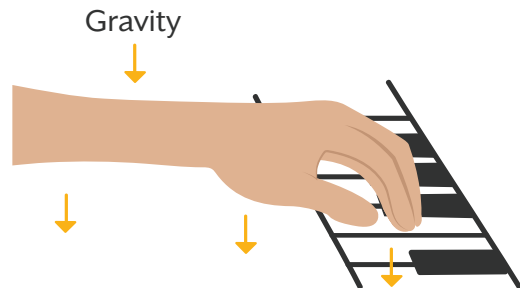
3 Arm Weight

Pianists use the natural weight of their arms as they play. To help discover the natural weight of your arms, imagine you are a puppet and both hands are being lifted up by strings.

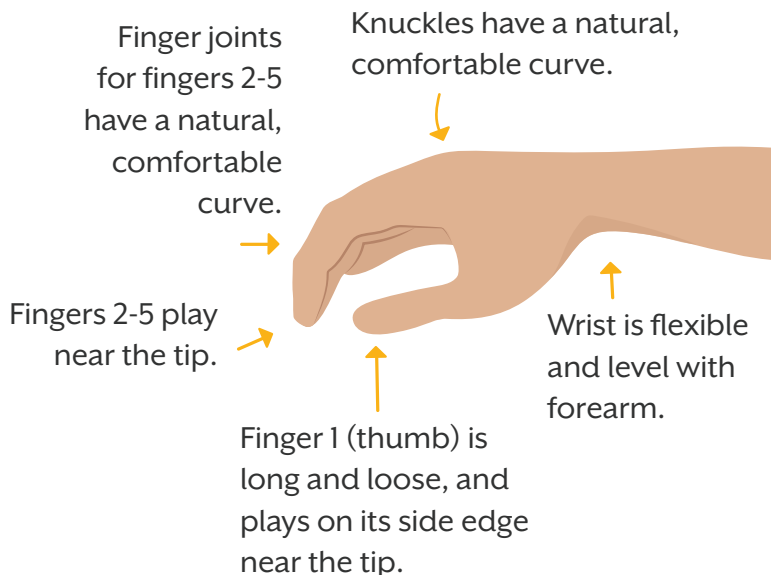


Now imagine that the strings get cut, and your hands and arms drop limply on your lap or by your side.

As you play the piano, think of your arm, hand, and fingers falling or dropping into each key. Instead of relying on finger motion, let gravity do most of the work for you! Mr. Hoffman or your teacher can demonstrate this for you.



4 Finger Shape



Avoid finger joints bending backward. Maintain proper curve by keeping finger joints firm as they strike the key.



Wrist should not be locked in a lowered position. (If this happens, bench may be too low.)



Wrist should not be locked in an elevated position. Knuckles should not be flat or concave.